The Bureau of Meteorology

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 9:35 pm CDT on Wednesday 21 October 2026
for the period until midnight CDT Saturday 24 October 2026.

Please be aware
Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A slow moving high pressure system in the Tasman Sea maintains a ridge across eastern parts of the state. A trough of low pressure is forecast to move into the west on Thursday, and slowly move eastwards on Friday. Another trough and multiple cold fronts move over the state over the weekend.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northwest to northeasterly in the morning then tending south to southeasterly 15 to 20 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore later in the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots turning southeasterly during the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning, then increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny day. The chance of a thunderstorm inshore at night.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly 15 to 25 knots during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres inshore. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

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Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southerly 15 to 20 knots in the early morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm at night.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly 15 to 25 knots during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres inshore during the afternoon or evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northwest to northeasterly in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southerly 15 to 20 knots in the early morning then tending southeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon or evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Central Coast

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots shifting west to northwesterly below 10 knots in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then tending southerly in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northwesterly during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

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Winds: West to northwesterly about 10 knots tending southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then tending southerly in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres west of Kangaroo Island. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon and evening.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then tending southerly in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon and evening.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots shifting north to northwesterly in the late morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon then decreasing to below 10 knots in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southerly 10 to 15 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon and evening.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming south to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots in the morning then tending south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5

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metres inshore during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southeast to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southerly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre around midday. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Northeast to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northeasterly in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day then tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre around midday. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning southerly 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 3:40 am CDT Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.

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